
North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

September 28, 2020

Ms. Debi Leal
Knights Bridge Vineyards
P.O. Box 1129
Calistoga, CA 94515
dkleal@knightsbridgewinery.com

Dear Mrs. Leal,

Subject: Notice of Applicability of General Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ, Knights Bridge Winery, Domestic Wastewater System, Calistoga, Sonoma County

File: Knights Bridge Winery Domestic Wastewater System, 17134 Spencer Lane, Calistoga CA; WDID No. 1B190006RSON; CIWQS Place No. 855819

This letter serves as Notice of Applicability (NOA) from the North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) that General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order) is applicable to the subject wastewater system and that the system is henceforth regulated under the General Order as described below. This letter also provides transmittal of Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) Order No. R1-2020-0036 for the subject wastewater system, Attachment 2 to this NOA.

Knights Bridge Vineyards (Discharger) submitted a report of waste discharge (ROWD) application and a Recycled Water Engineering Report (RWE Report) on February 1, 2019, for the Knights Bridge Winery (Winery) domestic wastewater system located at 17134 Spencer Lane, Calistoga, in Sonoma County. Supplemental information was provided on March 20, 2019. Revised design plans for the domestic wastewater system project were received on July 21, 2020 and August 7, 2020. The Division of Drinking Water (DDW) provided review of the RWE Report and the updated revised design plans. On July 30, 2020, DDW staff acknowledged via email that discharge from the WWTS is not subject to California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Water Recycling Criteria. Based on the information presented in the ROWD, and the revised design plans the proposed WWTS and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the General Order.

An ROWD application fee of \$2,953, that serves as the first annual fee, was received on September 17, 2020. The application fee reflects a Threat to Water Quality and Complexity rating of 3B and a 50 percent fee discount because the authorized discharge is a domestic waste discharge of less than 50,000 gallons per day (gpd).

The General Order contains requirements that apply to all types of wastewater systems and requirements that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Attachment 1 summarizes the operational requirements and the effluent limitations specific to the Knights Bridge Winery domestic wastewater system. The General Order contains additional requirements not summarized in Attachment 1. Additionally, the General Order requires compliance with Regional Water Board Basin Plan water quality objectives. The MRP, Attachment 2, contains the necessary site-specific monitoring and reporting requirements. The Discharger is responsible for all applicable requirements in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

The General Order is available on the [State Water Resources Control Board \(State Water Board\) website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) at:
https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

The Regional Water Board Basin Plan, Chapter 3, Water Quality Objectives, is available on the Regional Water Board website at:
https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water_issues/programs/basin_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf

Winery and WWTS Discharge Description

Knights Bridge Vineyards, plans to construct and operate the Winery at 17134 Spencer Lane, Calistoga, in Sonoma County. The Winery will be located in an area not served by a regional wastewater collection system; therefore, domestic and process wastewater will be collected and treated on-site.

Two separate wastewater treatment systems will serve the Winery. Domestic wastewater originating from the Winery's restrooms and sinks will be treated via a septic tank, and an aerobic, anoxic, membrane package treatment system followed by ultraviolet disinfection. The peak design flow for the domestic wastewater system is 210 gpd. Treated wastewater will be disposed of via surface drip to native vegetation in an area of the Winery referred to as "Rattlesnake Hill". Employee and guest access to the disposal field will be restricted by steeply sloped terrain and warning signs.

The operation and maintenance of the domestic wastewater system will be overseen by a licensed wastewater operator as per the State Water Board Wastewater Operator Certification Program. The wastewater system will be equipped with a control panel and alarm system. The Discharger is responsible for ensuring proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring of the wastewater system.

California Environmental Quality Act

On September 26, 2017, the Sonoma County Board of Supervisors adopted a Mitigated Negative Declaration (SCH No. 2016092067) with a mitigation monitoring plan, and approved Use Permit No. UPE13-0046 with conditions of approval, for the Winery. The Mitigated Negative Declaration found that the analysis prepared for the Mitigated Negative Declaration adequately addressed present day environmental concerns pursuant to the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA).

Annual Fees

The discharge authorized by this NOA is subject to payment of annual fees under the State Water Board annual fee schedule for regulated waste discharges. Annual fees are based in part on ratings for threat to water quality and complexity, and the treatment technology employed, as defined in the fee schedule listed in California Code of Regulations, Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 9, Waste Discharge Reports and Requirements, Article 1, Fees, Section 2200, Annual Fee Schedules and also available at:

[https://govt.westlaw.com/calregs/Document/IEEE14760D45A11DEA95CA4428EC25FA0?viewType=FullText&originationContext=documenttoc&transitionType=CategoryPageItem&contextData=\(sc.Default\)](https://govt.westlaw.com/calregs/Document/IEEE14760D45A11DEA95CA4428EC25FA0?viewType=FullText&originationContext=documenttoc&transitionType=CategoryPageItem&contextData=(sc.Default))

For more information on fees and answers to frequently asked questions please visit the following website,

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr

Questions or concerns about this NOA letter, or related matters, should be directed to Rachel Prat at (707) 576-2542 or Rachel.Prat@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,

Matthias St. John
Executive Officer

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Attachments:

1. Summary of WWTS Specific General Order Requirements
2. Monitoring and Reporting Program Order No. R1-2020-0036

cc: Emmy Myszka, Sonoma County PRM, emmy.myszka@sonoma-county.org
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